LaneLog

Week 1: App idea & design proposal

Elevator pitch

LaneLog is an Android app for saving bowling scores, notes, and photos of score sheets. It keeps those records together and shows a quick summary of past games.

Problem statement

The problem I want to solve is keeping a useful record after a bowling game ends. A photo can preserve the score, but a phone gallery does not make it easy to compare games or add bowling notes. A score written in a notes app also has to be sorted and averaged by hand.

Why this matters

A single score is easy to remember for a little while. Over several visits, it becomes harder to keep track of which games went well or what I wanted to work on. Having the date, score, and notes together would make those records easier to use later.

How people handle it now

People can take a picture of the score screen, write the result in a notes app, or enter scores into a spreadsheet. Those options save the information, but the score, photo, and notes may end up in different places. Comparing results takes extra work.

How LaneLog helps

I plan to let users save a game's final score, date, alley, and notes in one entry. They can attach a score photo and edit the entry later. The home screen will list past games and show the number of games, average score, and best score. Records will stay on the device and remain available after the app closes.

Target audience

I am the main target user. LaneLog could also suit casual bowlers who want a record of their games without entering every throw. I am planning around quick entry, readable scores, and access without an internet connection. The first version will focus on one person's completed games.

First version

I will build LaneLog in .NET 11 MAUI and use an Android phone or emulator for the demo. The three planned screens are Home, Add/Edit Game, and Settings. Settings will save a default bowling alley to reduce repeated typing.

2. Features and priorities

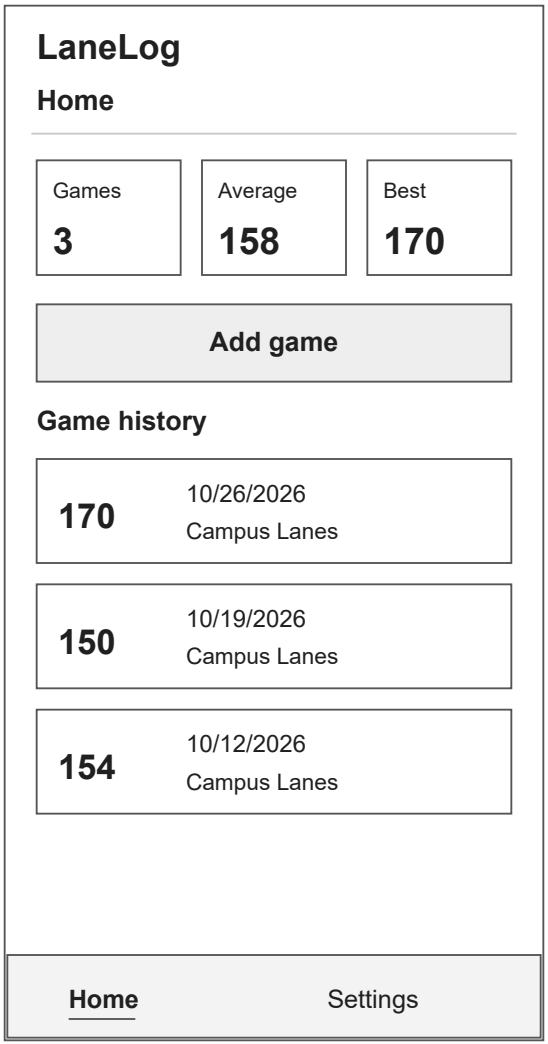
Must have features make the first version usable. Should have features improve it. Could have features can wait.

Priority	Feature	What it will do
Must have	**Home and game history**	List saved games and show the game count, average score, and best score.
Must have	**Add a game**	Enter a date and final score, with optional alley and notes.
Must have	**View and edit a game**	Open a saved entry and correct it without creating a second game.
Must have	**Score photo**	Attach one optional photo from the camera or photo picker and reopen it later.
Must have	**Local storage**	Keep games, notes, and attached photos after the app closes.
Must have	**Input checks**	Accept whole-number scores from 0 to 300 and show clear errors.
Must have	**Settings screen**	Save a default bowling alley and use it when starting a new entry.
Must have	**Readable controls**	Use clear labels, large enough buttons, and layouts that fit a phone.
Should have	**Delete a game**	Ask for confirmation before removing an unwanted entry.
Should have	**Search or filter**	Find past games by alley or date.
Should have	**Theme choice**	Let the user follow the phone theme or choose light or dark mode.
Could have	**Score trend chart**	Show how scores change over time.
Could have	**Export scores**	Save game records to a CSV file for use in a spreadsheet.

3. Low-fidelity wireframes

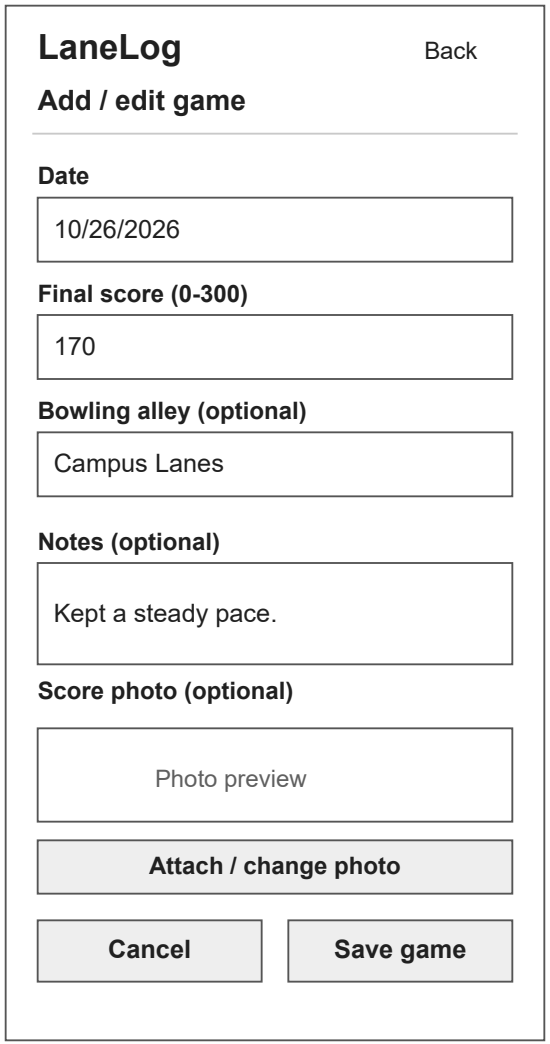
The boxes show the planned layout and main actions. Example scores and alley names are for the wireframes only.

Home screen



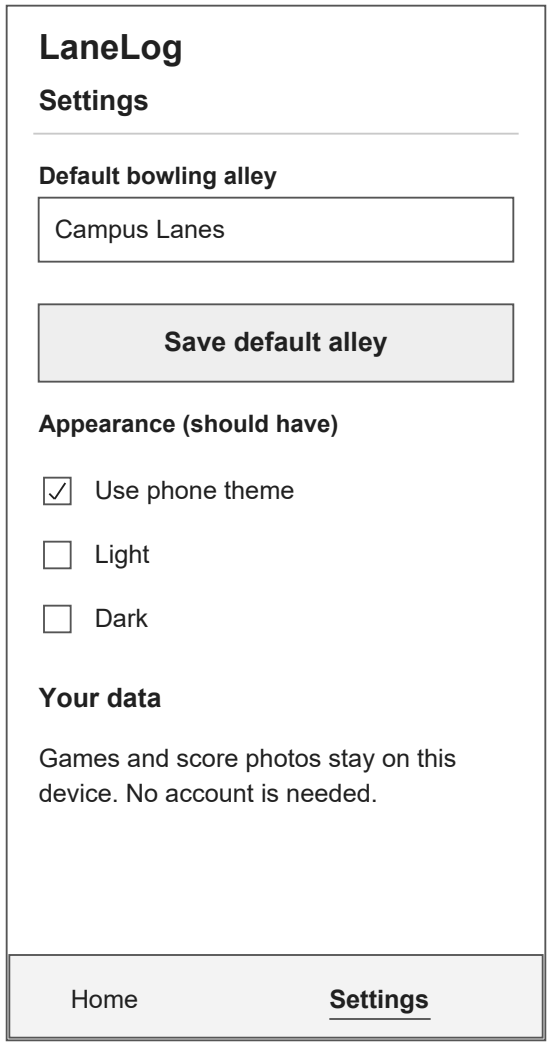
Tap Add game for a new entry. Tap a saved game to open and edit it.

Primary feature screen



Save returns to Home. Cancel keeps the saved game unchanged.

Settings screen



The default alley fills new game entries. Home returns to the game list.

Navigation: Home > Add/Edit Game > Save or Cancel > Home. Home and Settings use the bottom tabs.

4. Reflection

Deciding how much to include was the hardest part of planning LaneLog. A bowling app can grow quickly if it tries to track every throw, calculate handicaps, manage leagues, and compare several players. For this project, I chose to record a game's final score and a few notes. That gives me something useful to build in six weeks without turning it into a full scoring system.

I also had to decide what belongs on each screen. The home screen needs to show past games and a quick score summary. The game form needs enough room for a date, score, notes, and a photo. The settings screen can hold a default bowling alley so I don't need to type it every time. Keeping those jobs separate makes the layout easier to follow.

I am the main user I have in mind, so I focused on what I would want to do after finishing a game. I want to save the score quickly and look it up later. That led me to keep the first version local and avoid an account setup. A person should be able to open the app and start adding games. Clear score labels and simple error messages also matter, especially when a number is typed incorrectly.

The photo feature is the one I am most interested in building. A score alone shows the result, but a photo can keep the score sheet with it. I want to try selecting or taking a photo, saving it with a game, and opening it again after restarting the app.

This proposal gives me a starting point, but I still need to test the screens on Android. The wireframes may change once I see how the form fits with the keyboard open. My first goal is to get adding, editing, and saving games working before adding extra features.